Goldsmiths
UNIVERSITY OF LONDON

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION FOR DISINFORMATION DETECTION DASHBOARD

A Generalized Cross-Dataset ML and DL-based Fake News Detection Model and Dashboard Software

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Introduction

With the rapid development of digital technologies and the widespread availability of the Internet, access to news has become significantly easier. However, this accessibility has also intensified the spread of disinformation, which circulates faster than accurate information.
Fake or disinformative news have become a global challenge. Its impact spans psychological, behavioural, economic, and political domains.
You are invited to participate in a research study that evaluates the usability, functionality, and user experience of a disinformation detection system. Before deciding whether to participate, please read the following information carefully.

Purpose of the Study

This research provides the users an opportunity to identify fake or true news. Internally, the system uses AI models to identify authenticity of a news and explains to the user the why a certain news is true or false. The goal is to understand how users interact with the system and interpret prediction outputs.

- You must be at least 18 years old
- Have basic experience using a computer or web application.
- Have some familiarity with reading online news articles (e.g., occasionally or more)

The evaluation aims to:

- Assess the usability and accessibility of the fake news detection application.
- Evaluate user understanding of prediction results.
- Identify strengths and weaknesses in the UI/UX design.
- Improve user interaction and system performance.

What You Will Be Asked to Do

As a participant, you will:

- Access and interact with the application.
- Search and select news content using keywords or radio buttons.
- Detecting disinformation of fake news using one of the following:

    - Select a record from the dataset (radio buttons)
    - Select from Zip folder (preloaded news articles)
    - Upload your own file (TXT, PDF, DOCX, CSV etc)
- Obtain prediction from the application
- Review the system output and explanation with visualisation
- Complete a short usability questionnaire The session will take approximately less than 30 minutes.

Data Collection

The following information may be collected during the study:

- Anonymous Interaction logs within the system.
- Uploaded or selected text files.
- Questionnaire responses.
- System performance observations.

No personally identifiable or sensitive data will be collected.

What about privacy and confidentiality?

All collected data will be kept confidential and used only for academic and research purposes. Participant identities will remain anonymous in any publication or report.

How do I give my consent to participate?

Your participation is entirely voluntary. You may withdraw from the study at any time without providing a reason.

What are the possible risks for me if I take part?

There are no significant risks associated with participating in this study. Your participation will contribute to improving the usability and electiveness of disinformation detection systems.

What if I have questions about the research project?

If you have any question related the project, you can contact the researcher team.

Researcher Team

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Thank you for helping with this research project. Please keep this sheet for your information.